

Alikhan Beisenbayev

Visual Storyteller & Cartographer

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Profile

Cartographer and GIS developer with 3+ years of experience focused on map-making and interactive storytelling. Currently, writing a thesis for the MSc Cartography at TU Wien via the Erasmus Mundus Joint Master's program. Award-winning cartographic works recognized by the British Cartographic Society and GeoHipster. Skilled in the full workflow from Figma to Maplibre.

Awards

- Earth on Fire** 

Jul 2026

GeoHipster Calendar, Featured | Atlas of Sustainability, Featured
- Silk Road map**

Sep 2025

British Cartographic Society, Winner
- Tigranes the Greatest**

Mar 2025

Armenia Open Data Contest, Winner

Selected projects

- Heat Stress in Vienna (MSc Thesis)** 

- Designing and evaluating an interactive map-based narrative of urban heat stress across European cities. Research focuses on user engagement in scroll-driven cartographic storytelling.
- Tigranes The Greatest Storytelling** 

- Scroll-driven interactive map narrative of the ancient Armenian Empire under Tigranes II. Combined archival cartographic research with web-native data storytelling. Winner of the Armenia Open Data Contest.
- Ignition point analysis in Kazakhstan** 

- Full pipeline from retrieving, processing, and analyzing FIRMS fire points for 2001-2024 to writing an interactive report.
- Web map of Astana building's age** 

- Web map visualization of buildings, year of construction, their height, surface temperature, and urban greenness in Astana.
- Silk Road through Centuries** 

- Printed cartographic design showcasing the historical trade network focused on Central Asian routes. Winner of the British Cartographic Society.

Work Experience

- GIS Engineer**

Institute of Ionosphere

- Architected and delivered a wildfire monitoring web platform end-to-end — participating in UI/UX design in Figma, implementing interactive map components in React and OpenLayers.
 - Developed an interactive geospatial report to communicate spatial-temporal wildfire trends (2001–2024).
 - Performed multi-sensor wildfire analysis (MODIS & VIIRS) and transformed results into interactive geospatial storytelling. 

Dec 2024 – Feb 2026 | Kazakhstan, Remote
- Junior GIS Specialist**

Traceair technologies 

- Processed and optimized 200+ Digital Elevation Models (DEMs) within a web-based geospatial platform, improving terrain visualization accuracy for construction monitoring across active project sites.
 - Performed quality assurance of elevation datasets to enhance clarity of 3D terrain representations.

Sep 2023 – Sep 2024 | Armenia, Remote

GIS Analyst
KazGISA LLP 

Sep 2023 – Dec 2023 | Astana, Kazakhstan

- Architected and maintained scalable GIS infrastructure (GeoServer, PostGIS, QGIS) supporting a national geoportal platform.
- Boosted web map rendering speed by approximately 30% for large-scale vector datasets by migrating to Mapbox Vector Tiles (MVT), directly improving the responsiveness of the geoportal.

GIS Lab Technician

Sep 2022 – Jun 2023 | Long Beach, USA

Geography department at CSULB

- Redesigned department websites using Figma
- Supported 100+ students in ArcGIS, QGIS, and Python-based spatial analysis.
- Automated vegetation index (NDVI, AEVI, SAVI) computation workflows using Python for 100+ UAV images, reducing processing time by 50% and enabling faster ecological analysis for research faculty.
- Designed and deployed an ArcGIS Hub data portal to store and visualize UAV imagery for stakeholders.

GIS Intern

May 2022 – Aug 2022 | Online, Internship

HERE technologies

- Improved base map data quality through large-scale feature validation and spatial data enrichment workflows for HERE's base map.
- Designed and deployed interactive web mapping applications using Leaflet.js, optimizing usability and map interaction patterns.

Education

Master of Science in Cartography — Erasmus Mundus Scholarship
Technical University Munich (TUM)
Thesis: Evaluating User Engagement in an Interactive Map-Based Narrative of Heat Stress Across European Cities

Oct 2024 – Oct 2026 | Munich, Germany

Bachelor of engineering in geodesy and cartography, GPA - 3.8/4.0
L. N. Gumyilov Eurasian National University
Project: Web-based Satellite Image Analysis for Water Detection using NDWI and Leaflet

Sep 2018 – Jun 2022 | Astana, Kazakhstan

Skills

Data Vizualization: Information design, scrollytelling, dashboards, storytelling, D3.js, Flourish

Design: Figma (UI/UX, prototyping), Adobe Illustrator, Mapbox Studio, Blender, Webflow/Framer, Affinity

Cartography: Thematic cartography, narrative map design (storymaps), persuasive cartography, historical cartography, typography, and color theory

Web Mapping: MapLibre, Deck.gl, Leaflet, Mapbox, t-rex, Martin, Tippecanoe

Programming: JavaScript, React, Python (geopandas, scripting, automation), PostgreSQL, Git

GIS and Remote Sensing: QGIS, ArcGIS Pro, Google Earth Engine, GDAL

Languages

English (Full Professional) • **Russian** (Fluent) • **German** (A2, in progress)